Keep Track of Contacts, Handoffs, and Concerns as Your Husband's Care Begins

Four prompts to confirm who received what, know whom to reach for which kind of concern, pull the family's early worries into one list, and build a first-days log.

Where you are

Your husband is moving in, or a home care service starts this week. You've handed over papers, met several staff, and already have three concerns sitting in a group text with your kids.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can name who has his information, who to call about what, and what is still open, and you have one running log instead of a dozen messages.

A one-page first-days log: Information handed over and to whom, Who to contact for what, Open concerns with dates, and Questions for the first care-plan meeting.

Before you start

- Whatever you handed over or sent: a list, a folder, an email trail, or just your memory of it.
- Business cards, names, or a welcome sheet from the new provider.
- The family messages from the first few days, however scattered. You don't need to have sorted any of it.

PROMPT 1

Check what was actually received, not just sent

WHY THIS MATTERS

You gave the folder to someone at the front desk. That is not the same as the nurse having his medication list. Sent and received are two different columns.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

A list of what you handed over or sent, and who you think took it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> My husband just started with a new care provider. Here is everything we handed over or sent, and what I remember about who took it:

> [PASTE YOUR LIST OR NOTES]
>
> Make a table with columns: ITEM, HOW IT WAS GIVEN, WHO RECEIVED IT, and RECEIPT CONFIRMED (YES, NO, or DON'T KNOW). If I only know that something was sent, mark it DON'T KNOW. Pay particular attention to his medication list and any care instructions; if I cannot name who received those, put them at the top. Then write a short, polite message I can send asking the provider to confirm what they have on file. Do not comment on whether the information itself is correct.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

DON'T KNOW beside the medication list or care instructions. That's the first call to make.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Send the message and mark receipts as the answers come back.

PROMPT 2

Sort out who to call about what

WHY THIS MATTERS

In the first week you meet a dozen people and remember three. When something seems off at 7 p.m., you need to know which of them to call, and who covers when they're off.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The names and roles you've collected, and the situations you're worried might come up.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are the names, roles, and numbers I have collected from my husband's new care provider, and the situations I'm worried might come up:
>
> [PASTE THE NAMES AND ROLES]
>
> [PASTE THE SITUATIONS YOU'RE WORRIED ABOUT]
>
> Make a contact card with three sections: ROUTINE QUESTIONS, SOMETHING SEEMS WRONG TODAY, and AFTER HOURS OR URGENT. Place each person under the section where their role fits, and write NOT YET KNOWN where I have no one. Then list the questions I need to ask the provider to fill the NOT YET KNOWN spaces, including who covers when the main contact is off. Do not guess at anyone's role or add names I didn't give you.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A NOT YET KNOWN under 'something seems wrong today.' That gap matters most.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask the provider the questions on your next visit or call, and fill in the card.

PROMPT 3

Pull the family's concerns into one list

WHY THIS MATTERS

Your daughter noticed he wasn't wearing his glasses. Your son thinks dinner was late. You wondered about the night shift. Each worry is real, and each one is in a different thread.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The family messages or your summary of them, with who said what and roughly when.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> In the first days of my husband's new care arrangement, our family has been sharing worries by text and phone. Here is everything I can gather, with who said it and roughly when:
>
> [PASTE THE MESSAGES OR YOUR SUMMARY]
>
> Turn this into one list with columns: WHAT WAS NOTICED, WHO NOTICED IT, WHEN, RAISED WITH THE PROVIDER? (YES, NO, or DON'T KNOW), and RESPONSE SO FAR. Merge duplicates and keep the words close to what the family actually said. Do not rank the concerns by seriousness or tell me which ones to drop. If a concern is about medication or a fall, note that it should go to a nurse or the care manager, nothing more.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Concerns nobody raised with the provider yet, and concerns raised with no response recorded.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Choose one family member to keep this list and ask everyone to send new concerns to them.

PROMPT 4

Write the first-days log

WHY THIS MATTERS

Everything so far lives in three tables. The family needs one page they can all read, and you need something to carry into the first care-plan meeting.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The results of the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what I have gathered about my husband's first days with the new provider:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Put it on one page with four headings: INFORMATION HANDED OVER AND TO WHOM, WHO TO CONTACT FOR WHAT, OPEN CONCERNS WITH DATES, and QUESTIONS FOR THE FIRST CARE-PLAN MEETING. Under the last heading, turn each unresolved item into a plain question I can ask at the meeting. Leave open items open. Do not mark anything as resolved unless I told you it was, and do not offer an opinion on how the care is going.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

One page you could read to your kids in two minutes so everyone is current.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask the provider when the first care-plan meeting is, and bring the page.

Give the new team the whole picture.

A first-days log tracks what changed hands. The care interview organizes your husband's situation into one Family Care Profile, so what you know at home is written down and can travel with him.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›